when the Supreme Leader, Ali Khamenei, met Roger Garaudy, a French Holocaust denier, for the first time. Later, he claimed, that the "exaggerated numbers" of Jews killed in the Holocaust were "fabricated." While Rouhani's current government avoids this theme, Holocaust denial has remained an essential component of Iran's official doctrine. "It's not clear what the reality is about it [the Holocaust—MK], whether it even has a reality, or how it happened," declared Ali Khamenei in March 2014.[22]

Third, after the revolution, Khomeini's paranoid attitude towards Israel became the policy of a powerful state. Already during Yasser Arafat's visit to Iran shortly after the revolution, Khomeini proclaimed "*imruz iran, farad felestin*"—"today Iran, tomorrow Palestine"—implying that the "liberation of Palestine" would come next.[23] Khomeini and all his followers had (and have) no doubt that this "liberation" requires the elimination of Israel.

Since 1979, whenever a compromise between Arabs and Israel "threatened" to mitigate the Middle East conflict, Tehran did everything to thwart a peaceful solution. The antisemitic hatred behind this behavior has a long tradition. "All Arabs who collaborate with the Jews should be destroyed before they help the Jews destroy us," announced Nazi Germany's Arabic-language radio program back in April 1943.[24] A generation later, Khomeini declared: "It is the duty of all Islamic countries to completely eradicate Israel. . . . Any relation with Israel and its agents. . .is religiously prohibited and constitutes hostility to Islam."[25] A generation later, Ahmadinejad exclaimed: "If someone. . .recognize[s] the Zionist regime – he should know that he will burn in the fire of the Islamic *Ummah* [nation]."[26] The eradication of Israel—with or without Arab support—has remained Iran's priority up to the present day.

We are thus confronted, in the case of Iran, with a particular form of antisemitism. Our review has shown that Tehran's hatred of Israel is inextricably linked to its antisemitic worldview, including Holocaust denial and conspiracy fantasies. Nevertheless, the regime tolerates Iranian Jews as a protected subordinated minority and, as a rule, draws a distinction between Zionism as a menace and Judaism as a legitimate religion. A "good Jew" within this framework is someone who is willing to support Tehran's antisemitic program and Israel's elimination. Only such Jews – the fanatical followers of the *Neturei Karta* sect, the intimidated leaders of the Iranian Jewish community, or some useful idiots of the Jewish radical left—are acceptable to Tehran.

How then did the Western world react when Mahmoud Ahmadinejad brought the Islamic Republic of Iran's latent antisemitism into the open and placed it at the center of the country's foreign policy?

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